Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

953
14 1.46%
Sep 15th, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1064
13.69 1.30%
Sep 15th, 2023

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

838
8 1.00%
Sep 15th, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

104.70
0.08 0.08%
Sep 15th, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

136.00
1.33 0.99%
Sep 15th, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1055
30 2.93%
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2401 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

879.00
15.50 1.80%
Sep 15th, 2023 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
October 23 USD/dmt

123.40
2.85 2.36%
Sep 15th, 2023 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2401 (Jan) RMB/t

3824
30 0.79%
Sep 15th, 2023 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

20.21
0.14 0.69%
Sep 14th, 2023

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

8.56
0.20 2.39%
Sep 14th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3820
40 1.06%
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

115.42
-0.25 -0.22%
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

11.89
-0.31 -2.52%
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3910
30 0.77%
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Sep 15th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	953	14	1.5%	869	880	858	892	123.89	1.98	1.6%	120.06	120.58	117.93	122.93
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	838	8	1.0%	813	798	761	793	109.79	1.26	1.2%	113.29	110.17	105.29	110.04
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1064	14	1.3%	981	992	970	1003	138.86	2.00	1.5%	136.05	136.43	133.84	138.73

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Sep 15th, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	104.70	0.08	0.08%	113.14	121.10	83.90	146.75
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	136.00	1.33	0.99%	122.80	135.46	94.45	147.55

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE I2401 iron ore contract closed up 2.33% at 879 yuan/mt today. Traders were motivated to ship goods and iron ore quotations were firm. The wait-and-see sentiment among steel mills intensified, and the overall transaction atmosphere was sluggish. PBF at Shandong port dealt 943-947 yuan/mt; increased 8-12 yuan/mt over yesterday. SSF at Shandong port dealt 812 yuan/mt; increased 2 yuan/mt over yesterday.
The total inventory of iron ore at the 35 ports in China tracked by SMM was 115.42 million mt, which was down 25,000 mt WoW, and 12.33 million mt l ower than the same period last year. The average daily cargo pick-up from ports increased by 37,000 mt on a week-on-week basis to 3.082 million mt. Driven by the high output of pig iron and inventory replenishment before the National Day, cargo pick-up volume increased. According to SMM's survey, some steel mills' imported ore replenishment rose obviously with about 10 days of usage. Strong de mand for iron ore provided support for ore prices. On the macro front, PBOC once again lowered the reserve ratio by 0.25 percentage points, which sti mulated market sentiment, so short-term mineral prices may continue to fluctuate at high levels.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1055	30	2.9%	940	1017	770	1055	131.60	3.84	3.00%	120.27	134.80	94.72	137.26

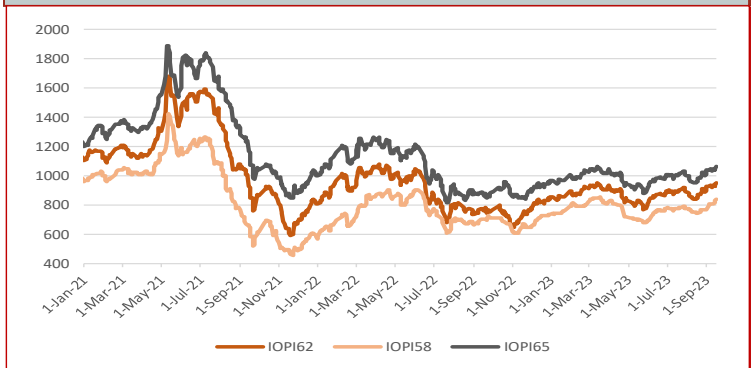
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1066	1.9%	779	1645	148.18	1.91%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1105	0.5%	780	1630	153.61	0.45%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	800	0.0%	620	1310	111.21	0.00%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1168	1.9%	800	1752	162.36	1.92%	117.19	272.32

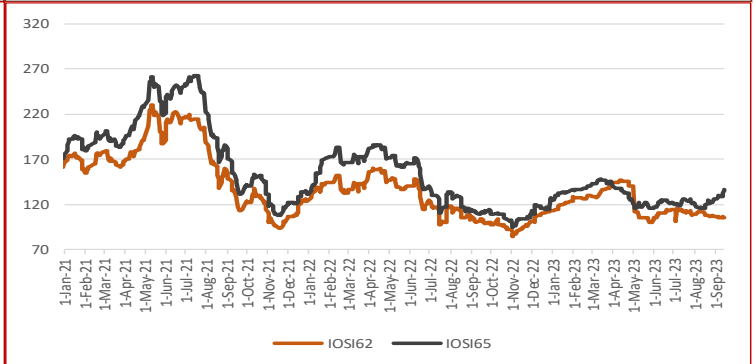
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	990.12	1.06%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.87528

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 15th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	804	863	896	873	869	881	880	106.85	112.38	116.58	113.28	120.06	120.90	120.58
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	698	748	777	759	813	792	798	93.21	97.98	101.68	99.13	113.29	109.35	110.17
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	916	975	1008	985	981	993	992	122.23	127.41	131.57	128.31	136.05	136.72	136.43

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Sep 15th, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	108.53	110.54	108.57	109.02	112.14	112.94	121.10
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	127.20	135.30	147.39	119.61	122.86	122.92	135.46

FREIGHT RATES

Sep 14th, 2023		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	8.56	0.20	2.39%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	20.21	0.14	0.69%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD	May	June	July	August	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	919	969	980	951	933	937	1017	117.67	121.33	122.51	118.96	119.96	120.28	134.98

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Sep 15th, 2023		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-114	-11.98%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	11.73%

Sep 15th, 2023		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	31.30	29.89%

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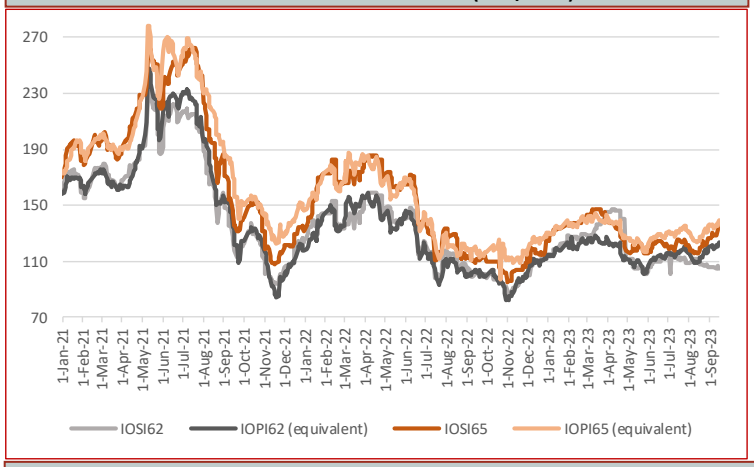
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Sep 15th, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	896	14	-57
SIMEC Fines	827	14	-126
PB Fines	920	14	-33
Newman Fines	922	14	-31
MAC Fines	903	14	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	818	14	-135
Carajas Fines	1134	14	181
Brazilian SSF	918	14	-35
Brazilian Blend Fines	934	14	-19
RTX Fines	836	14	-117
West Pilbara Fines	864	14	-89

Sep 15th, 2023	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	100.20	0.10	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	96.70	0.10	-8.00
PB Fines	100.95	0.10	-3.75
Newman Fines	103.85	0.10	-0.85
MAC Fines	100.95	0.10	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	93.35	0.10	-11.35
Carajas Fines	134.25	0.10	29.55
Brazilian SSF	108.45	0.10	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	110.10	0.15	5.40
RTX Fines	94.60	0.10	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	98.95	0.10	-5.75

Sep 15th, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	838	8	0
FMG Blended Fines	848	8	10
Robe River	849	8	11
Western Fines	852	8	14
Atlas Fines	846	9	8
Yandi	830	8	-8

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	15.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	27.00	2.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	9.00	2.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	14.00	-5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	15.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	37.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	9.00	4.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	34.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade	10.00	4.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.75	-0.25
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.75	-0.25
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.75	-0.25
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	1.00	-0.50
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	1.00	-0.25
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	3.75	-0.50
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.00	-0.25
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.50	0.25

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-5.00	0.00	Jingtang	-5.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-15.00	0.00

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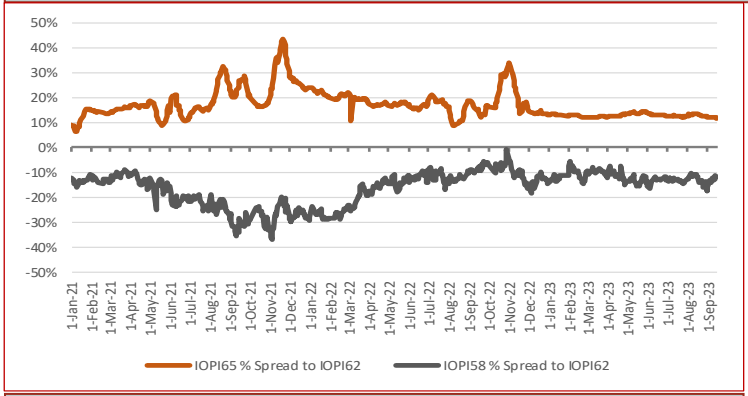
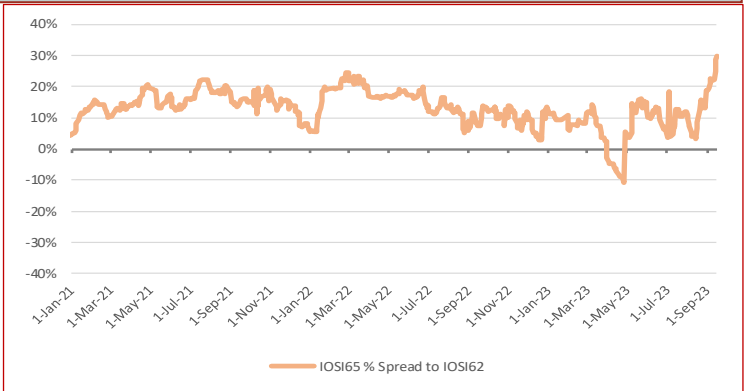
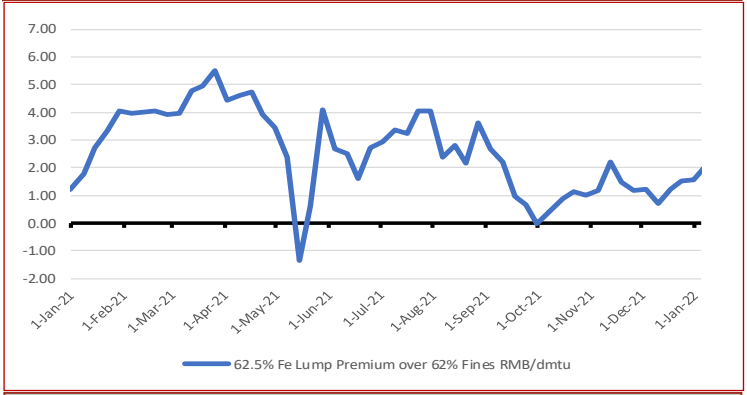
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

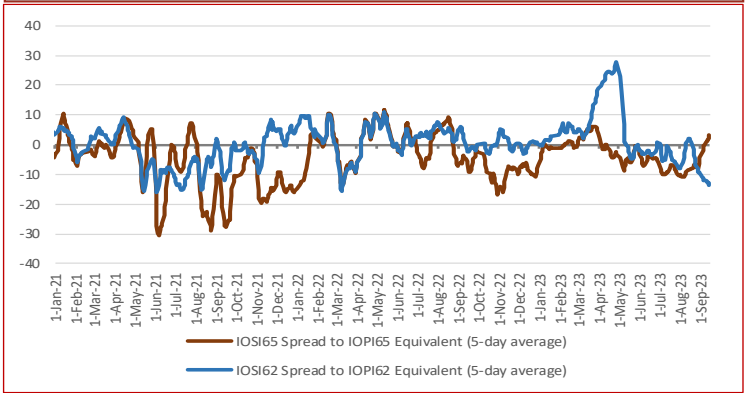




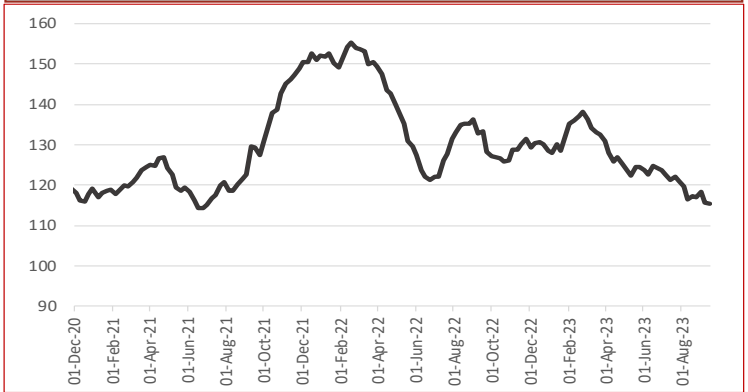
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



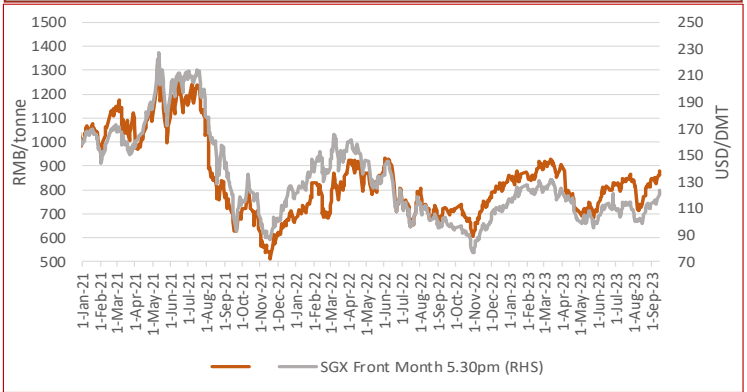
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

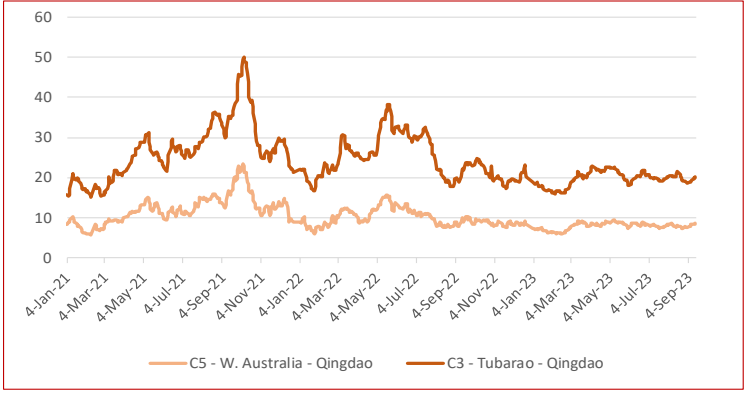
Week Ending Sep 15th, 2023

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	11.02	-2.48%	9.84	19.20
Qingdao	24.06	0.84%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	11.45	-3.46%	9.05	16.29
Tianjin	7.63	-11.07%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	12.94	2.94%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	115.42	-0.22%	98.80	155.39

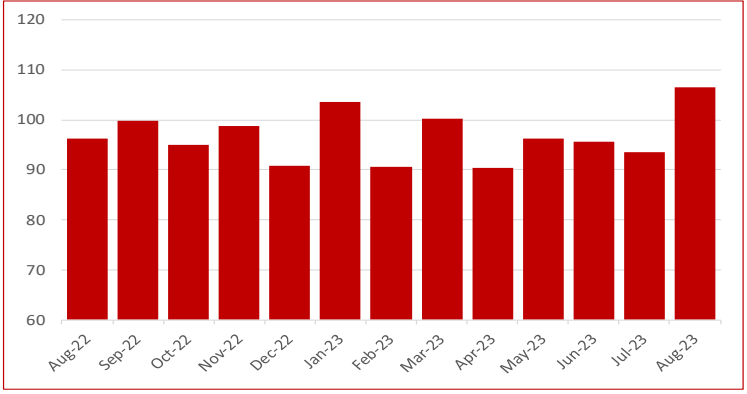
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Sep 15th, 3pm close			Sep 15th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2401	Change	Change %	Oct. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	879.00	15.50	1.80%	123.40	2.85	2.36%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	54.70	-1.42	-2.54%	9.60	1.09	12.80%
Open positions ('000 lots)	79.66	1.66	2.13%	40.67	0.93	2.35%
Day Low	866.5	13.00	1.52%	119.05	0.70	0.59%
Day High	881.5	15.00	1.73%	123.75	3.00	2.48%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2023/9/15	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,820	40	1.06%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	4,000	30	0.76%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,910	30	0.77%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,840	40	0.83%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,920	-10	-0.25%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,080	30	0.59%
Colour Coated Plate	7,000	50	0.72%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

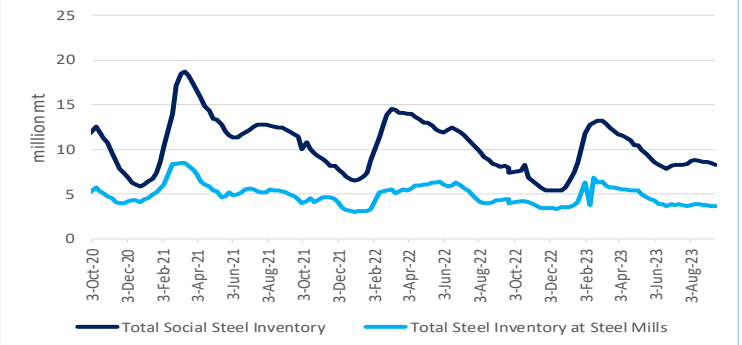
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	104.62	-1	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,340	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,920	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,157	23	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,793	26	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-63	44	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,841	26	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	29	-6	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

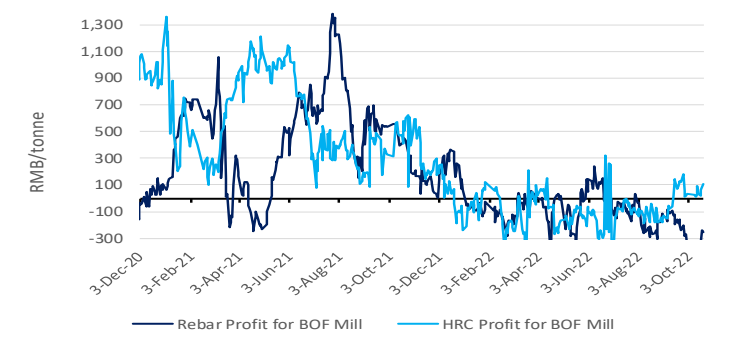
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

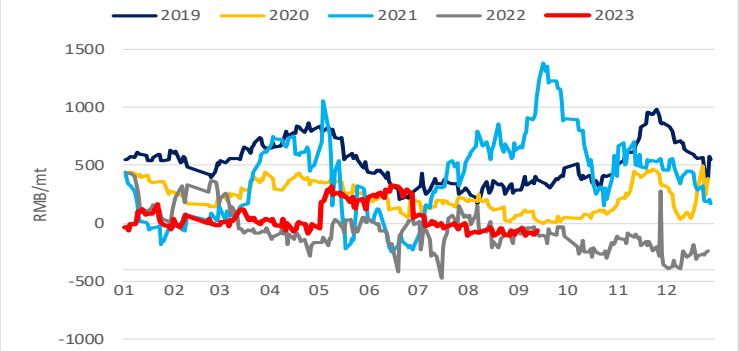
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



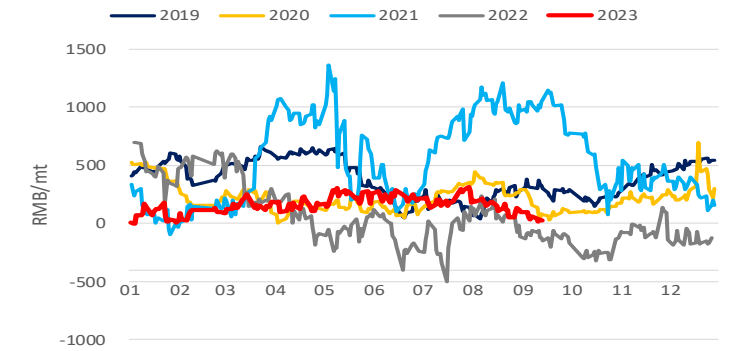
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



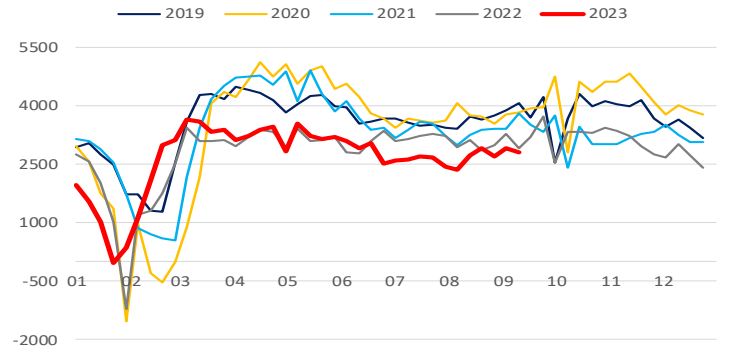
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



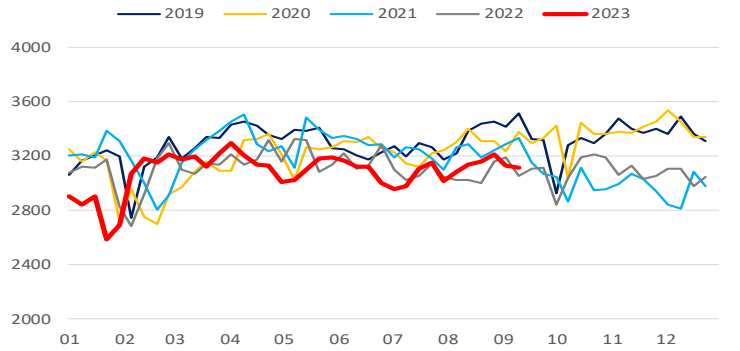
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



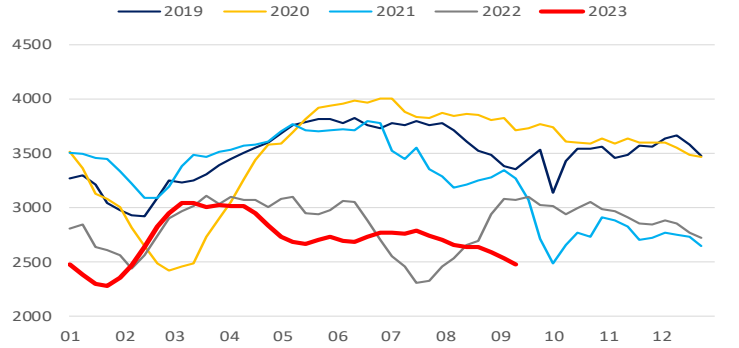
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



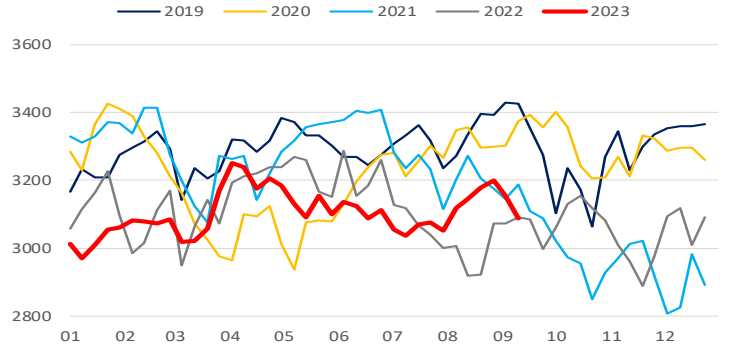
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Sep 15th, 2023	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Sep 15th, 2023	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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